Module 4, Lesson 4.2: Calendar Intelligence

The Calendar Chaos Problem

Your calendar should be a tool that serves you. For most people, it's become a source of stress instead.

- Meetings pile up with no breathing room
- Scheduling becomes an endless email chain
- Time zones create confusion
- Commitments conflict with priorities
- Your calendar runs you, not the other way around

Calendar intelligence means transforming your calendar from a passive record of commitments into an active tool that protects your time, optimizes your schedule, and handles the tedious logistics of scheduling.

What Calendar Intelligence Looks Like

Level 1: Calendar Awareness

Your AI agent monitors your calendar and:

- Knows your upcoming commitments
- Alerts you to conflicts
- Reminds you of upcoming meetings
- Provides daily briefings

You still manage scheduling, but you're always informed.

Level 2: Calendar Assistance

Your AI agent actively helps:

- Proposes meeting times based on your preferences
- Drafts scheduling emails
- Identifies scheduling conflicts
- Suggests optimal times for different activities

You make decisions, but logistics are handled.

Level 3: Calendar Automation

Your AI agent manages scheduling autonomously:

- Handles routine scheduling requests
- Automatically proposes and confirms times
- Reschedules when conflicts arise
- Protects your focused work time

You're involved only in non-routine scheduling decisions.

Setting Up Calendar Integration

Configuration

Add calendar configuration to your OpenClaw config:

```yaml
calendar:
  provider: google  # or outlook, apple

  # Permissions
  read: true        # Can read your calendar
  write: true       # Can add/edit events

  # Safety settings
  require_confirmation: true  # Confirm before booking
  draft_mode: true           # Draft events for review

  # Preferences
  default_meeting_length: 30  # minutes
  timezone: America/New_York
  business_hours:
    start: "09:00"
    end: "17:00"
```

Connecting Your Calendar

For Google Calendar:

1. Enable Google Calendar API
2. Authorize OpenClaw access
3. Select which calendars to include

For Outlook:

1. Enable Microsoft Graph API access
2. Authorize OpenClaw
3. Configure calendar permissions

For Apple Calendar:

1. Use CalDAV integration
2. Authorize access
3. Select calendars

Calendar Preferences

Define your preferences in AGENTS.md:

```
## Calendar Preferences

### Working Hours
- Monday-Friday: 9 AM - 5 PM
- Prefer meetings: 10 AM - 12 PM, 2 PM - 4 PM
- Avoid meetings: Before 9 AM, after 5 PM, lunch (12-1 PM)

### Meeting Preferences
- Default meeting length: 30 minutes
- Buffer time between meetings: 10 minutes
- Maximum meetings per day: 6
- Prefer back-to-back or spread out: Spread out

### Focus Time
- Block 2-hour focus blocks: 9-11 AM, Tuesday and Thursday
- Don't schedule over focus blocks
- Emergency override: Only with explicit approval

### Scheduling Rules
- Never schedule more than 2 weeks in advance without asking
- Always include video link for remote meetings
- Confirm meetings 24 hours before
- Check for conflicts before proposing times

### Meeting Types
- Client calls: Up to 60 minutes, morning preferred
- Internal syncs: 30 minutes, afternoon OK
- Networking calls: 30 minutes, flexible
- Deep work sessions: 2+ hours, morning only
```

Calendar Awareness: Knowing Your Time

Start with read-only capabilities:

Daily Briefing

Prompt your agent: “What does my calendar look like today?”

Your agent provides:

```
📅 Today's Schedule - Wednesday, January 15

🔵 Morning Focus Block: 9:00 - 11:00 AM
   [Protected time - no meetings]

📞 Client Call - Acme Corp: 11:30 AM - 12:00 PM
   Sarah Johnson, project status update
   Zoom link: [link]

🍽️ Lunch Break: 12:00 - 1:00 PM

👥 Team Sync: 1:30 - 2:00 PM
   Weekly team meeting
   Conference room B

📞 Prospect Call - NewCo: 3:00 - 3:30 PM
   Initial consultation call
   Notes: They found us through referral

📝 Buffer Time: 4:00 - 5:00 PM
   [Open for quick meetings or wrap-up]

⚠️ Reminders:
- Prepare Acme Corp status update (call in 2 hours)
- NewCo might need pricing info ready
- Team sync: Bring project updates

📊 Day Summary:
- 3 meetings (2.5 hours)
- 2 hours focus time protected
- 1 hour buffer time available
```

Weekly Overview

“What’s my week looking like?”

```
📅 Week of January 13-17

Monday:
- 4 meetings (3.5 hours)
- Light day - good for deep work

Tuesday:
- 6 meetings (5 hours) ⚠️ Heavy day
- Focus block protected (9-11 AM)

Wednesday:
- 3 meetings (2.5 hours)
- Afternoon mostly open

Thursday:
- 2 meetings (1.5 hours)
- Focus block protected (9-11 AM)
- Ideal for project work

Friday:
- 1 meeting (0.5 hours)
- Very light - catch-up day

📊 Week Summary:
- 16 meetings total (12.5 hours)
- 4 hours of protected focus time
- Heaviest day: Tuesday
- Best for deep work: Thursday, Friday

💡 Suggestions:
- Consider moving one meeting from Tuesday
- Thursday is ideal for that project work you mentioned
- Friday could be used for planning next week
```

Conflict Detection

Your agent proactively identifies issues:

"⚠ Scheduling Conflict Detected: You have two meetings at 2 PM tomorrow:

1. Client call with Acme Corp
2. Team sync

Which one should take priority, or should I propose rescheduling one?”

Time Analysis

“Analyze my calendar for the past month. How am I spending my time?”

```
📊 Time Analysis - Past 30 Days

Meeting Time: 47 hours (23% of work hours)
├── Client calls: 18 hours (38%)
├── Internal meetings: 15 hours (32%)
├── Networking: 8 hours (17%)
└── Other: 6 hours (13%)

Focus Time: 35 hours (17% of work hours)
├── Protected blocks used: 28 hours (80%)
└── Protected blocks interrupted: 7 hours (20%)

Available Time: 122 hours (60% of work hours)

⚠️ Insights:
- You're in meetings 23% of the time
- 20% of your focus blocks were interrupted
- Friday is consistently your lightest day
- Most meetings are in the afternoon

💡 Recommendations:
- Protect focus blocks more aggressively
- Consider batching meetings on specific days
- Friday could host more meetings if needed
```

Calendar Assistance: Active Scheduling Help

Once you’re comfortable with calendar awareness, add active assistance:

Proposing Meeting Times

When you need to schedule a meeting:

“I need to schedule a 30-minute call with Sarah from Acme Corp. Propose 3 times that work.”

Your agent:

1. Checks your calendar for available slots
2. Considers your preferences (morning for clients)
3. Adds buffer time
4. Proposes times:

```
📅 Proposed Times for Acme Corp Call (30 min):

1. Tuesday, Jan 14 at 10:00 AM
   ✅ Within your preferred client meeting window
   ✅ Morning focus block ends at 11, plenty of buffer

2. Wednesday, Jan 15 at 11:30 AM
   ✅ Morning slot
   ✅ Before your lunch break

3. Thursday, Jan 16 at 2:00 PM
   ✅ Afternoon, but your schedule is light
   ✅ Good buffer after

Which would you like me to propose?
```

Drafting Scheduling Emails

“Draft an email to Sarah proposing these times.”

```
To: Sarah Johnson <sarah@acmecorp.com>
Subject: Scheduling Our Call

Hi Sarah,

I'd love to connect to discuss the project status. Would any of these times
work for you?

• Tuesday, Jan 14 at 10:00 AM ET
• Wednesday, Jan 15 at 11:30 AM ET
• Thursday, Jan 16 at 2:00 PM ET

Let me know what works best, and I'll send a calendar invite.

Best,
[Your name]
```

Handling Scheduling Requests

When someone asks to meet:

"John asked for a meeting next week. Find 3 times that work."

Your agent:

1. Reviews your calendar for next week
2. Identifies available slots
3. Applies your preferences
4. Proposes times

Time Zone Handling

"My client in London wants to meet. What times work for both of us?"

```
📅 Times that work in both time zones:
(Eastern Time / London Time)

Tuesday:
- 9:00 AM ET / 2:00 PM London
- 10:00 AM ET / 3:00 PM London

Wednesday:
- 9:00 AM ET / 2:00 PM London
- 10:00 AM ET / 3:00 PM London

Thursday:
- 9:00 AM ET / 2:00 PM London
- 11:00 AM ET / 4:00 PM London

💡 Your morning works well for their afternoon.
```

Calendar Automation: Autonomous Scheduling

The highest level is letting your agent handle routine scheduling:

What Can Be Automated

Fully Automated:

- Confirming meetings at times you've pre-approved
- Rescheduling around conflicts using your preferences
- Sending reminders before meetings
- Adding video links automatically

Semi-Automated:

- Proposing times for new meeting requests
- Handling back-and-forth scheduling
- Adjusting for time zones

Human Required:

- Prioritizing conflicting meetings
- Scheduling with VIP contacts
- Non-routine or complex scheduling

Automation Rules

Define rules for your agent:

```
## Calendar Automation Rules

### Auto-Confirm If:
- Time is within your preferred meeting hours
- You have no conflicts
- Meeting is with a known contact
- Duration is 30 minutes or less

### Auto-Propose If:
- Someone requests a meeting
- Time is available
- Meeting fits your preferences

### Always Ask If:
- Meeting is over 60 minutes
- Meeting is outside business hours
- Meeting is with a new contact
- There are any conflicts
```

Handling Rescheduling

When conflicts arise:

"⚠ Conflict detected: Your 2 PM call overlaps with your focus block tomorrow. How would you like to handle this?

1. Move the call to 3 PM (available)
2. Move the call to Thursday (you're light that day)
3. Cancel the focus block for this week
4. Decline the meeting request

What's your preference?"

Meeting Reminders

Automate preparation:

```
🔔 Upcoming Meeting Reminder

📅 Client Call - Acme Corp
⏰ 30 minutes from now (11:30 AM)

📋 Last Meeting Notes:
- Discussed Q1 priorities
- Sarah mentioned budget concerns
- Agreed to prepare ROI analysis

📎 Files Referenced:
- /Projects/Acme/notes.md
- /Projects/Acme/proposal.pdf

📝 Preparation Suggested:
- Review ROI analysis
- Prepare budget options
- Have timeline ready

Would you like me to pull up the relevant files?
```

Protecting Your Time

Calendar intelligence isn't just about scheduling—it's about protecting your time for what matters.

Focus Blocks

Define protected time for deep work:

"Block 9-11 AM every Tuesday and Thursday for focus work. No meetings unless it's an emergency."

Your agent:

1. Creates recurring focus blocks
2. Rejects meeting requests during those times
3. Asks before making exceptions
4. Tracks how often focus blocks are respected

Meeting Budgets

Set limits on meeting time:

"Limit my meetings to 4 hours per day maximum."

Your agent:

1. Monitors daily meeting time
2. Warns when approaching limit
3. Suggests rescheduling if over limit
4. Provides weekly meeting time reports

Buffer Time

Ensure transitions between meetings:

"Always leave 10 minutes between meetings."

Your agent:

1. Schedules buffer time automatically
2. Proposes times that include buffers
3. Protects buffers from being scheduled over
4. Respects your need for transitions

Declining Gracefully

When you need to decline:

"Decline the team meeting tomorrow. I have a conflict with my focus block. Draft a polite decline."

```
Hi [Organizer],

Unfortunately, I won't be able to join tomorrow's team meeting. I have a
prior commitment during that time.

Could you share the agenda or notes afterward? I'd like to stay in the loop
on what's discussed.

Thanks,
[Your name]
```

Calendar Integration with Other Systems

Calendar + Email

Connect scheduling across systems:

“When someone emails asking for a meeting, check my calendar and propose 3 times.”

“When a meeting is confirmed via email, add it to my calendar automatically.”

Calendar + Tasks

Link calendar to your task system:

“Before my Acme Corp call, remind me to review the project status.”

“Block 1 hour tomorrow for working on the proposal task.”

Calendar + Memory

Build context from calendar:

“Remember that I have a monthly check-in with Acme on the first Tuesday.”

“After each client call, note key points in the project notes.”

Advanced Calendar Intelligence

Smart Scheduling

Your agent learns your preferences over time:

“I notice you tend to accept client calls in the morning and decline afternoon meetings on Fridays. Should I apply this as a preference?”

Calendar Analytics

Track how you spend your time:

“Show me a breakdown of my meetings last month by type.”

```
📊 Meeting Breakdown - Last 30 Days

By Type:
- Client calls: 18 hours (38%)
- Internal meetings: 15 hours (32%)
- Networking: 8 hours (17%)
- One-on-ones: 6 hours (13%)

By Duration:
- 15 min: 4 meetings
- 30 min: 22 meetings
- 60 min: 8 meetings
- 90+ min: 2 meetings

By Day:
- Monday: 3.5 hours
- Tuesday: 5 hours
- Wednesday: 2.5 hours
- Thursday: 1.5 hours
- Friday: 0.5 hours

💡 Patterns:
- Your longest meetings are client calls
- Tuesday is your heaviest day
- Friday afternoons are consistently free
```

Predictive Scheduling

Anticipate needs:

“Your weekly team sync is usually on Wednesdays at 1 PM. I don’t see it on this week’s calendar. Should I check if it’s still happening?”

“The project deadline is in 2 weeks. Would you like me to block time for final preparation?”

Calendar Best Practices

The 50-Minute Meeting

Default to 50-minute meetings instead of 60:

- Gives you 10 minutes between meetings
- Most meetings don’t need the full hour
- Creates natural buffer time

The No-Meeting Day

Designate one day with no meetings:

- Pick your most productive day
- Block the entire day for focus work
- Protect it fiercely

The Meeting Cost Calculation

Before accepting meetings, consider:

- Duration × hourly rate = meeting cost
- Number of attendees × duration × average rate = total cost
- Is the outcome worth the cost?

The Pre-Meeting Prep

Always prepare before meetings:

- Review previous notes
- Check attendee list
- Know the agenda
- Have your objectives ready

The Post-Meeting Capture

After meetings, capture:

- Key decisions
- Action items
- Follow-ups
- Next steps

Coming Up Next

In Lesson 4.3, we'll explore content creation pipelines—how to use AI to generate, refine, and publish content at scale without sacrificing quality.

Key Takeaways

1. **Calendar should serve you, not rule you** - Active management vs. passive recording
2. **Protect focus time aggressively** - Your most valuable work happens in uninterrupted blocks
3. **Automate routine scheduling** - Save decision fatigue for important choices
4. **Analyze your time regularly** - You can't optimize what you don't measure
5. **Integrate calendar with other systems** - Email, tasks, and memory work together